

Using CLI as a tool for nest project

Asked 5 years, 5 months ago Modified 10 months ago Viewed 25k times



I'm new in nodejs/nestjs, I want to build a new nest project and want to install nest cli as a command-line interface tool

12



I've tried on the following instruction from nest documentation the first step is to install nest/cli globally and when I tried the second steps which are using nest command it always end up showing an error that "nest" is not recognized as an internal or external command



step 1



```
$ npm i -g @nestjs/cli
```

step 2

```
$ nest new project-name
```

the error

```
'nest' is not recognized as an internal or external command,  
operable program or batch file.
```

command-line-interface nestjs

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edited May 24, 2019 at 5:07



Russ Cam

125k ● 34 ● 208 ● 272

asked May 22, 2019 at 4:07



Dyna Rizki Habibah

141 ● 1 ● 1 ● 5

8 Answers

Sorted by: Highest score (default)



The global npm binaries are probably not on your `PATH`, you have to add them:

8

Run the command `npm root -g` to find out where your global modules are installed, e.g.

```
C:\Users\<username>\AppData\Roaming\npm\node_modules .
```



Then add `C:\Users\<username>\AppData\Roaming\npm` (without `node_modules`) to your `PATH`.



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answered May 22, 2019 at 6:22



Kim Kern

59.6k ● 19 ● 215 ● 209

I added the global npm binary to the path following your response but it didn't work , but when I added specifically the nestjs `C:\Users\<username>\AppData\Roaming\npm\node_modules\@nestjs\cli` to the PATH and restarted vs code it worked , not sure why the first one didnt work though . – [Chakib Salah](#)
May 12, 2022 at 11:24



1. Find the npm global path like this

6

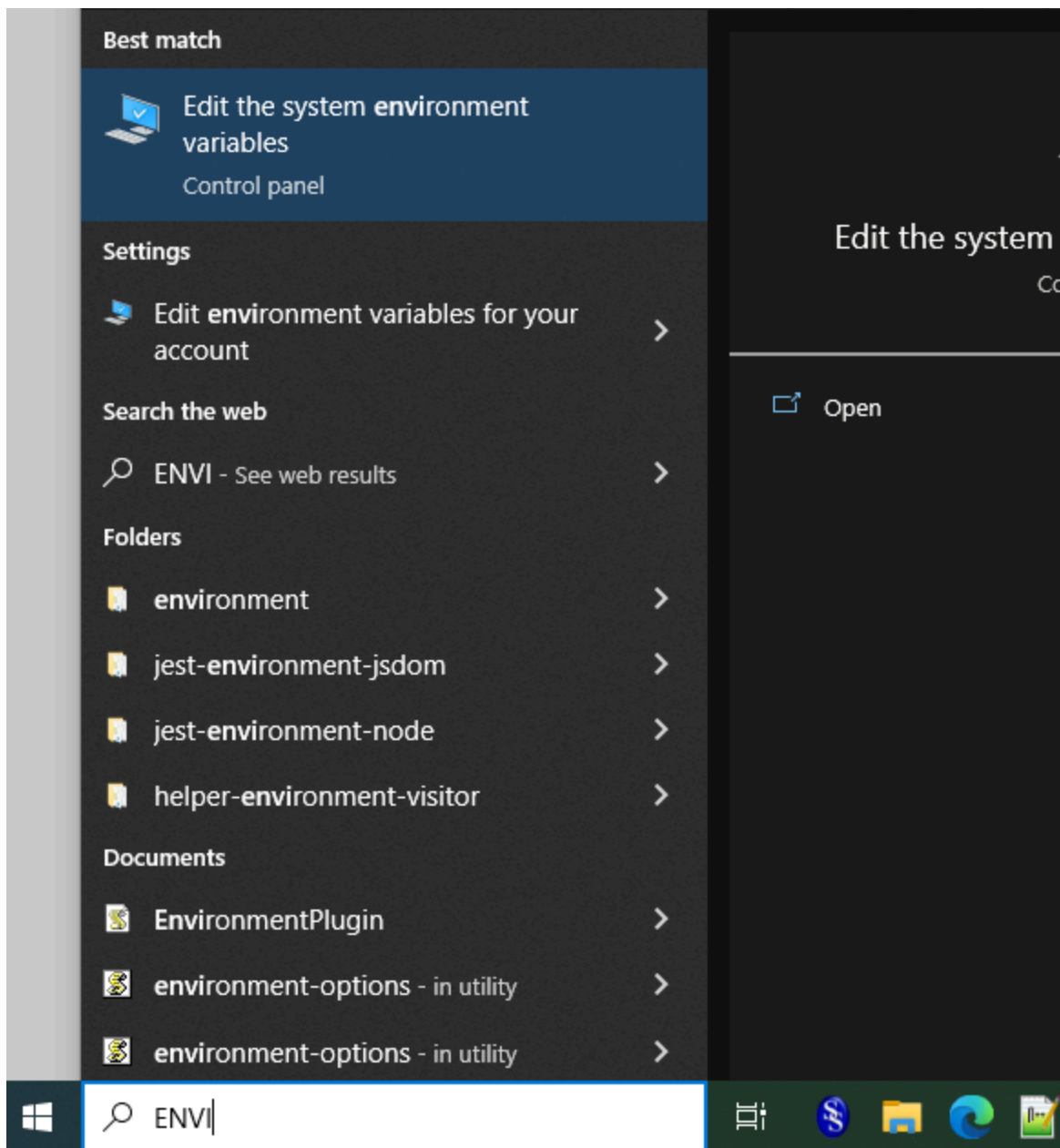
```
npm root -g
```



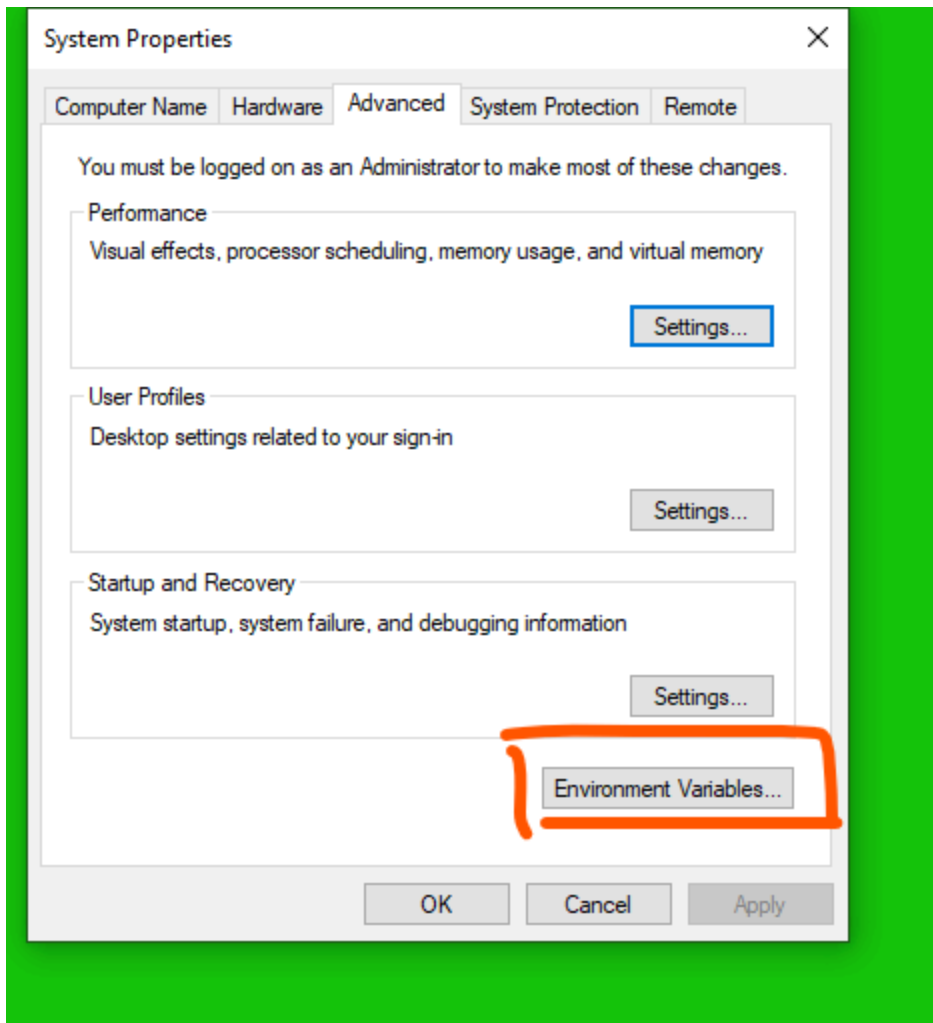
Select C:\WINDOWS\system32\cmd.exe

```
C:\Users\Hasif>npm root -g
C:\Users\Hasif\AppData\Roaming\npm\node_modules
C:\Users\Hasif>
```

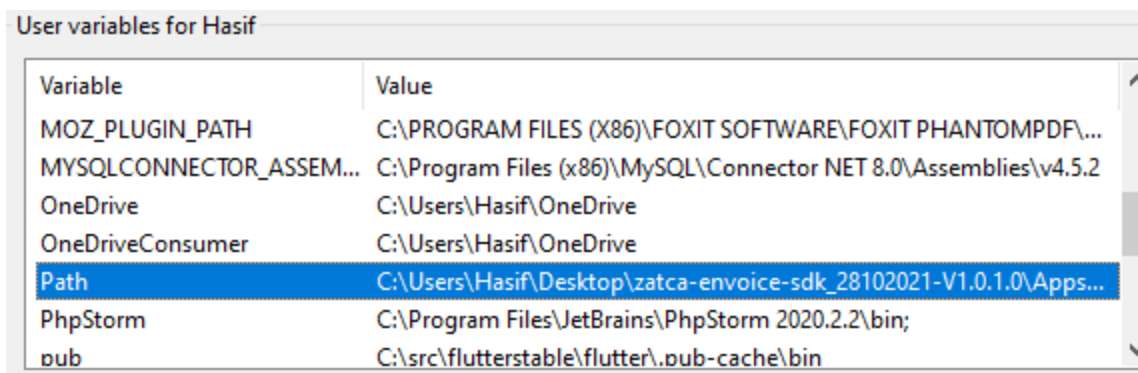
2. Open EnvironMent variable



3. Select Environment Variables



4. Double Click on user defined variable path



5. Click on New Button and add the location in underlined row

Edit environment variable



C:\Program Files (x86)\VMware\VMware Workstation\bin\
C:\Program Files\Common Files\Microsoft Shared\Microsoft Onlin...
C:\Program Files (x86)\Common Files\Microsoft Shared\Microsoft ...
C:\Program Files\Microsoft MPI\Bin\
C:\Program Files (x86)\Common Files\Oracle\Java\javapath
C:\WINDOWS\system32
C:\WINDOWS
C:\WINDOWS\System32\Wbem
C:\WINDOWS\System32\WindowsPowerShell\v1.0\
C:\WINDOWS\System32\OpenSSH\
C:\Program Files (x86)\Microsoft SQL Server\100\Tools\Binn\
C:\Program Files\Microsoft SQL Server\100\Tools\Binn\
C:\Program Files\Microsoft SQL Server\100\DTS\Binn\
C:\Program Files (x86)\Microsoft SQL Server\100\Tools\Binn\VSSHe...
C:\Program Files (x86)\Microsoft Visual Studio 9.0\Common7\IDE\...
C:\Program Files (x86)\Microsoft SQL Server\100\DTS\Binn\
C:\Program Files\dotnet\
C:\Pr
C:\Users\Hasif\AppData\Local\Programs\Microsoft VS Code\bin
C:\Users\Hasif\AppData\Roaming\npm

New
Edit
Browse...
Delete
Move Up
Move Down
Edit text...

OK Cancel

6. Now Take new command prompt and type `where nest` or `nest` Now it Works

```

:\Users\Hasif>where nest
:\Users\Hasif\AppData\Roaming\npm\nest
:\Users\Hasif\AppData\Roaming\npm\nest.cmd

:\Users\Hasif>nest
Usage: nest <command> [options]

Options:
  -v, --version      Output the current version.
  -h, --help         Output usage information.

Commands:
  new|n [options] [name]  Generate Nest application.
  build [options] [app]   Build Nest application.
  start [options] [app]   Run Nest application.
  info|i                 Display Nest project details.
  update|u [options]      Update Nest dependencies.
  add [options] <library> Adds support for an external library to your project.
  generate|g [options] <schematic> [name] [path] Generate a Nest element.

Schematics available on @nestjs/schematics collection:

```

name	alias	description
application	application	Generate a new application workspace
class	cl	Generate a new class
configuration	config	Generate a CLI configuration file
controller	co	Generate a controller declaration
decorator	d	Generate a custom decorator
filter	f	Generate a filter declaration
gateway	ga	Generate a gateway declaration
guard	gu	Generate a guard declaration
interceptor	in	Generate an interceptor declaration
interface	interface	Generate an interface
middleware	mi	Generate a middleware declaration
module	mo	Generate a module declaration
pipe	pi	Generate a pipe declaration
provider	pr	Generate a provider declaration
resolver	r	Generate a GraphQL resolver declaration
service	s	Generate a service declaration

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answered Jan 8, 2022 at 9:16



lava

7,183 ● 2 ● 40 ● 33

npx @nestjs/cli new project-name

3

This works for me for creating a project but didn't work to create a module for example.

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answered Sep 21, 2021 at 21:18



Gabriel Baldez

41 ● 1 ● 3

 Fix the same problem by adding `nest` to system variables manually.

0

1. On the Windows desktop, right-click **My Computer**.
2. In the pop-up menu, click **Properties**.
3. In the **System Properties** window, click the **Advanced** tab, and then click **Environment Variables**.
4. In the **System Variables** window, highlight **Path**, and click **Edit**.

5. In the **Edit System Variables** window, insert the cursor at the end of the **Variable** value field.
6. If the last character is not a semi-colon (;), add one.
7. After the final semi-colon, type the full path to the file you want to find. For example: path C:\jdk
8. Click **OK** in each open window.

[Step by step guide took from here](#)

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answered Sep 10, 2019 at 11:11



chavy

1,070 ● 14 ● 20



In most cases, it is better to use npx instead of installing global npm packages, since you'll always use the latest version.

0

Just replace nest with npx @nestjs/cli for any command:



npx @nestjs/cli new project-name



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answered Jan 6, 2021 at 7:34



saurabh

7 ● 2



```
npm root -g
```

0

Select C:\WINDOWS\system32\cmd.exe



```
C:\Users\Hasif>npm root -g  
C:\Users\Hasif\AppData\Roaming\npm\node_modules
```



```
C:\Users\Hasif>
```

you can use core nodejs way

```
node "C:\Users\Hasif\AppData\Roaming\npm\node_modules\@nestjs\cli\bin\nest.js" new  
project-name
```

this will be work like original command

```
nest new project-name
```

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answered Feb 23, 2022 at 20:40

[Shantanu Sharma](#)

684 ● 7 ● 21



First check the global path

0

```
npm root -g
```



Then make sure nest cli is installed inside the node_modules there. In my case I forgot that I'm using NVM and switch to version where it doesn't have nest cli installed.

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answered Dec 10, 2023 at 16:36

[Lutfi HP](#)

21 ● 2



We need to install nest. in document cli- nest forum i found that.

-1

```
npm install -g @nestjs/cli
```



hope that useful.

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answered Jan 12, 2021 at 9:37

[anhtn.dev](#)

19 ● 1

1 The asker wrote that s/he did that in step 1 already... – [PMO1948](#) Jan 12, 2021 at 10:00